Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Malatsi orders faster broadband rollout as Icasa seeks to cut internet costs** — The Citizen, 22 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's communications minister Solly Malatsi issued a policy direction to Icasa under the Electronic Communications Act, gazetted on 20 October 2026, building on the 2023 rapid-deployment policy. It directs a review of the 2010 Facilities Leasing Regulations, new rapid-deployment regulations, a national GIS database of communications infrastructure and a dispute-resolution process between operators and landowners. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **LIBERIA JOINS SMART AFRICA ALLIANCE AS 43RD MEMBER, ADVANCING PRESIDENT BOAKAI'S DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION AGENDA** — The Executive Mansion, Liberia, 22 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Liberia became the 43rd member of the Smart Africa Alliance, the admission completed by a delegation led by Minister of State for Presidential Affairs Samuel Stevquoah on the margins of the Global AI and Digital Summit in Seoul. The Executive Mansion presented it as part of President Boakai's digital agenda, pointing to training through the Smart Africa Digital Academy. *Also under Regional collaboration*.

Legislation and regulation

- **UCC Moves to Tighten Monitoring of Internet Data Resellers** — Nile Post, 22 October 2026 UGANDA

  The Uganda Communications Commission agreed with mobile operators and licensed internet providers in ISPAU to tighten tracking of data consumption and billing, aimed at unlicensed resellers of bulk connectivity over public Wi-Fi. Eligible resellers are to be brought into licensing through onboarding guidelines, and illegal access points and routers removed; no date or design for the monitoring was given. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **Egypt's Souhoola Secures FRA Approval for Fintech-Based Consumer Finance** — Tech Africa News, 22 October 2026 EGYPT

  Egypt's Financial Regulatory Authority licensed Souhoola to provide fintech-based consumer finance through V-Lens, covering electronic identification and verification, e-KYC, electronic contracts and digital record-keeping. The application was approved because it predated FRA Resolution No. 43 of February 2026, which suspended new fintech consumer-finance licence applications for a year. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS*.

Data protection

- **MTN Rwanda signs cybersecurity MoU with National Cyber Security Authority** — Tech Review Africa, 22 October 2026 RWANDA

MTN Rwanda signed a memorandum of understanding with the National Cyber Security Authority to support cybersecurity and data-protection skills training through the CyberHub Academy and Innovation Centre. No value or duration was stated. *Also under Cybersecurity and Training and skills.*

- **Mozambique joins SADC Regional Working Group on Data Protection** — Tech Review Africa, 22 October 2026
  MOZAMBIQUE SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Mozambique joined the SADC Regional Working Group on Data Protection through INTIC, naming board chair Lourino Chemane as member and data protection head Rosa Dique as alternate, after SADC ICT ministers meeting in Bulawayo on 26 June 2026 asked states to appoint representatives. The country's personal data protection bill is before the Assembly of the Republic. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

- **Ghanaian clinic stored patient records on an unassessed system before regulator intervened** — MyJoyOnline, 22 October 2026 GHANA

  A Ghanaian laboratory scientist and journalist argued that the Data Protection Commission's inspections of 12 October 2026 raise questions about national health record systems. The Commission found one clinic with no data protection supervisor, unpaid fees and no privacy impact assessment of its electronic records system, and referred it to the police; two hospitals had expired certificates. *Also under Sectoral management information systems and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **AU Member States Validate African Continental Health Data Governance Framework** — Africa CDC, 22 October 2026 AFRICA

  AU member states validated the African Continental Health Data Governance Framework in Addis Ababa on 22 October 2026, the first common continental approach to governing health data, proposing a federated model for sharing across borders. Africa CDC will finalise it with the agreed amendments and take it through AU policy processes, with consideration expected in 2027. *Also under Regional collaboration and Data Exchange.*

Regional collaboration

- **أن تكشف طريقة استخدامه AFRINIC قبل توسيع احتياطي نقاط تبادل الإنترنت، على** — btw.media, 22 October 2026 AFRICA

  BTW Media argued that AFRINIC should disclose how its IPv4 reserve for internet exchange points is being used before the community decides whether to enlarge it from a /16 to a /15. AFRINIC's policy keeps a contiguous /24 beside each peering assignment so an exchange can grow to a /23 without renumbering, but its extended statistics file does not separate reserved blocks, so the remaining contiguous space cannot be seen. Minutes of the AFRINIC-37 policy meeting of 24 June 2026 record staff promising consumption figures and NAPafrica describing two Johannesburg /23 blocks close to needing a /22. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **Rwanda, Ghana, Benin test cross-border digital identity verification** — The New Times, 22 October 2026
  RWANDA GHANA BENIN

  Rwanda, Ghana and Benin completed the first phase of a Smart Africa pilot linking their national ID systems through the Smart Africa Data Exchange, verifying identities end to end with synthetic data in a test environment. Smart Africa said the exchange passes verification requests between national systems without storing records centrally, and does not change visa or immigration rules. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Data Exchange.*

- **Gabon/Télécommunications : l'ARTAC adopte de nouveaux textes et accueille São Tomé-et-Príncipe - AGP - Agence Gabonaise de Presse** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 22 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

The Central African telecoms regulators' assembly ARTAC closed its 4th extraordinary session in Libreville on 21 October 2026 by adopting revised statutes, rules of procedure and financial regulations and admitting São Tomé and Príncipe's regulator. Executive president Christian Katende called for the roadmaps of the six permanent working groups to be put into effect.

- **ARTAC : Libreville acte une réforme importante et accueille São Tomé-et-Príncipe** — GabonReview, 22 October 2026 SÃO TOMÉ CENTRAL AFRICA

  A second account of the ARTAC closing session, adding that São Tomé and Príncipe's admission brings membership from seven countries to eight.

- **Afrique centrale : à Libreville, les régulateurs télécoms de l'ARTAC posent les bases d'un marché unique du numérique** — TechAfrika, 22 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  An account of the opening of the ARTAC session in Libreville on 20 October 2026, where Gabon's digital economy minister Mark-Alexandre Doumba called regulatory harmonisation a political act and a step toward a single Central African digital market. Delegations came from DR Congo, Congo, Cameroon, Chad, Equatorial Guinea, the Central African Republic and São Tomé and Príncipe, and the six working groups created on 29 May 2026 were formally launched.

- **Mozambique joins SADC Regional Working Group on Data Protection** — Tech Review Africa, 22 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Summarised under Data protection.

- **LIBERIA JOINS SMART AFRICA ALLIANCE AS 43RD MEMBER, ADVANCING PRESIDENT BOAKAI'S DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION AGENDA** — The Executive Mansion, Liberia, 22 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **AU Member States Validate African Continental Health Data Governance Framework** — Africa CDC, 22 October 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Ghana's hospitals are adopting AI, but the machines were never trained on Ghanaian patients** — MyJoyOnline, 22 October 2026 GHANA

  A Ghanaian journalist, drawing on an investigative documentary, argued that AI diagnostic tools now used in Ghana's health facilities, such as TB screening and smartphone ultrasound, were mostly trained on foreign patients and may err more often on Ghanaians without warning. The piece says adoption has outrun regulation. *Also under AI.*

- **Ghanaian clinic stored patient records on an unassessed system before regulator intervened** — MyJoyOnline, 22 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Assinaturas de internet fixa aumentam 14,7% num ano** — Expresso das Ilhas, 22 October 2026 CAPE VERDE

Cabo Verde's fixed broadband subscriptions grew 14.7% year on year in the second quarter of 2026, according to the regulator ARME, within 500,263 internet access subscriptions in total, 85% of them mobile broadband on phones. CVTelecom held 72.6% of internet subscriptions, Unitel T+ 26.5% and Starlink 0.87%, and mobile SIM penetration stood at 114% in June 2026.

- **أن تكشف طريقة استخدامه AFRINIC قبل توسيع احتياطي نقاط تبادل الإنترنت، على** — btw.media, 22 October 2026 AFRICA

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- **UCC Moves to Tighten Monitoring of Internet Data Resellers** — Nile Post, 22 October 2026 UGANDA

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- **Malatsi orders faster broadband rollout as Icasa seeks to cut internet costs** — The Citizen, 22 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Data Storage

- **Nigeria loses $850m yearly to foreign cloud dependence, Luminate study finds** — BusinessDay NG, 22 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Luminate's chief executive Melanie Hui told the BUILD 2026 conference in Abuja that Nigeria loses an estimated $850 million a year by relying on foreign cloud providers, citing research Luminate commissioned from the Global Centre on AI Governance. She urged African governments to judge foreign tech investment by the jobs, skills and value it keeps at home. *Also under AI and Digital sovereignty.*

- **Mzansi Mind advances South Africa's sovereign AI ambitions with HPE infrastructure** — Hewlett Packard Enterprise, 22 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  HPE announced that Mzansi Mind, Solcon Capital's enterprise AI platform built on its Siya language model for all official South African languages, chose HPE servers with NVIDIA Blackwell GPUs and HPE Juniper switches, hosted at Equinix's Johannesburg data centre. The platform cites local regulatory and data-residency requirements and plans to extend to other African markets. *Also under AI.*

- **FG proposes shared AI computing infrastructure with Rwanda, Senegal, Kenya** — TheCable, 22 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's communications minister Bosun Tijani, speaking through NCAIR's director at BUILD 2026 in Abuja, proposed pooling GPU capacity with Rwanda, Senegal and Kenya so researchers could combine compute to train large models. He said about 20 million Nigerians remain offline and pointed to a proposed Nigeria-Togo data park at Egbe to use unused power capacity. *Also under AI and Technical Capacity.*

- **Africa must own its digital future or risk exploitation, says Luminate CEO** — TechCabal, 22 October 2026 NIGERIA AFRICA

  A second account of Luminate chief executive Melanie Hui's BUILD 2026 keynote, adding her point from the same commissioned research that Africa's undersea internet cables follow old trade and extraction routes. *Also under Digital sovereignty and AI.*

Technical Capacity

- **FG proposes shared AI computing infrastructure with Rwanda, Senegal, Kenya** — TheCable, 22 October 2026 NIGERIA

Summarised under Data Storage.

Cybersecurity

- **We Must Build Cybersecurity Alongside Digital Infrastructure, Says NITDA DG** — ThisDay, 22 October 2026 NIGERIA

  NITDA's director general Kachifu Abdulahi used a press conference in Abuja to announce an International Cyber Security Conference there on 27-28 October 2026, themed on cyber resilience in the age of AI. He described the split of responsibility under the Cybercrimes Act, with the National Security Adviser's coordination centre over NITDA for ministries and citizens, the NCC for telecoms and the Central Bank for banks, and called for a national cybersecurity architecture setting minimum standards.

- **SENSIBILISATION - La prévention de la cybercriminalité se renforce** — L'Express de Madagascar, 22 October 2026 MADAGASCAR

  Madagascar's digital development ministry handed computers on 21 October 2026 to the Centre de lutte contre la cybercriminalité, which resumed work in June 2026 after an interruption, for its teams in all 24 regions. Under a responsible cyber-citizenship programme, regional staff are to be trained to detect offences on social media; the centre's coordinator said awareness comes first, with sanctions possible for those who persist.

- **Cybercrime crackdown in Africa nets 1,462 arrests, recovers over USD 105 million** — INTERPOL, 22 October 2026 AFRICA

  INTERPOL's Operation Serengeti III, run by police in 21 countries from 29 June to 31 August 2026, arrested 1,462 suspects, disrupted 10,909 malicious networks and recovered more than USD 105 million, against identified losses above USD 385 million and 65,929 victims. In Uganda alone, 365 foreign nationals were arrested over investment and pension frauds aimed at victims in Asia; the operation was co-funded by the EU-Council of Europe GLACY-e project.

- **CSA and NITA order government institutions to fix critical PHP vulnerabilities within seven days** — MyJoyOnline, 22 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's Cyber Security Authority and NITA issued a joint alert on 22 October 2026 ordering all government institutions to patch two critical PHP flaws (CVE-2026-109618 and CVE-2026-109619) within seven days and report what they did. Fixed PHP releases are available, and NITA will coordinate support for government systems under its Government Digital Assurance Programme.

- **MTN Rwanda signs cybersecurity MoU with National Cyber Security Authority** — Tech Review Africa, 22 October 2026 RWANDA

  Summarised under Data protection.

DPI

Data Exchange

- **Kenya ICT Authority signs AI Data cooperation agreement with South Korea's K-DATA** — Tech Review Africa, 22 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's ICT Authority signed a letter of intent in Seoul with the Korea Data Agency (K-DATA) to prepare government data for AI and pilot AI in public services, witnessed by ICT Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo. The cooperation also covers data governance, interoperability, secure data exchange across government, data quality certification and training, within the Data Protection Act 2019. *Also under AI.*

- **Rwanda, Ghana, Benin test cross-border digital identity verification** — The New Times, 22 October 2026 RWANDA GHANA BENIN

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- **AU Member States Validate African Continental Health Data Governance Framework** — Africa CDC, 22 October 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Uganda moves to make national digital ID number its tax identifier** — Biometric Update, 22 October 2026 UGANDA

  Uganda's Minister of State for Finance, Amos Lugoloobi, told Parliament the government is proceeding with making the National Identification Number the tax identifier for individuals, under a 2025 amendment to the Tax Procedures Code; companies keep a URSB registration number. The Uganda Revenue Authority has bought 80 biometric fingerprint scanners to link ID details to tax records, deployed first in Kampala and Wakiso with a wider rollout from 26 October. URA counts about 5.4 million individual taxpayers, of whom about 3.3 million are active. *Also under Registries.*

- **South Africa's digital ID could change how you pay** — TechCentral, 22 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  DIDx, a South African digital identity firm with a commercial stake in the outcome, told TechCentral that a credential from home affairs' MyMzansi digital ID app could seed a payment credential under the Reserve Bank's PEMKey programme, sparing users a second onboarding. The Reserve Bank has not said whether MyMzansi credentials will be accepted or published the PEMKey sandbox participants. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **Somalia enrolls citizens returning from Yemen for biometric national IDs** — Biometric Update, 22 October 2026 SOMALIA

  Somalia's National Identification and Registration Authority began enrolling citizens returning from Yemen for biometric national ID cards, working with the National Commission for Refugees and IDPs at its reception camp. NIRA puts national enrolment at about two million against a target of 15 million by 2029, and the Halmeel unified government services platform, covering about 70 services, is due by the end of March 2027. *Also under Access to services.*

- **Rwanda, Ghana, Benin test cross-border digital identity verification** — The New Times, 22 October 2026 RWANDA GHANA BENIN

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- **Egypt's Souhoola Secures FRA Approval for Fintech-Based Consumer Finance** — Tech Africa News, 22 October 2026 EGYPT

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Gabon Connect : TrésorPay, DUS… le Gabon mise sur le numérique pour mieux encaisser** — GabonReview, 22 October 2026 GABON

Gabon's vice-president of the government, Hermann Immongault, presented the next phase of the Gabon Connect single digital window in Libreville on 22 October 2026, deploying the single salary declaration (DUS) and TrésorPay portals. The platform groups eTax, eEmployeur, TrésorPay for non-tax and local-government revenue, eDouane and ePropriété, with full deployment due by December 2027. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **South Africa's digital ID could change how you pay** — TechCentral, 22 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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Registries

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Sectoral management information systems

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  Summarised under Data protection.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Consumer Protection Agency head: AI used to analyse complaints and detect violation patterns** — Cairo Governorate Electronic Portal, 22 October 2026 EGYPT

  The head of Egypt's Consumer Protection Agency, Ibrahim El-Segini, told Egypt Forum 2026 that the agency uses AI on complaints, inspection data, prices, adverts and online stores to spot violation patterns and high-risk sectors. It is also building a unified electronic inspection system tied to a central database and upgrading its complaints system to sort and route reports automatically. *Also under AI.*

- **Gabon Connect : TrésorPay, DUS… le Gabon mise sur le numérique pour mieux encaisser** — GabonReview, 22 October 2026 GABON

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

Technology

AI

- **Intelligence artificielle : La plateforme YIRI entend faciliter l'accès au numérique grâce aux langues locales** — Linfodrome, 22 October 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  FuturAfric launched YIRI in Abidjan on 15 October 2026, an AI-based social network and online marketplace working in Ivorian languages, with six covered so far and Baoulé and Dioula 70% complete. Its locally hosted corpus holds about 50,000 translated sentences and 300 annotated audio files, the founders aim to reach 80% of West Africa within three years, and the digital transition ministry was asked to back it. *Also under Digital divides.*

- **Côte d'Ivoire promotes national languages in AI development through YIRI digital community** — Tech Review Africa, 22 October 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  A second account of the YIRI launch, adding that it aims to build a voice and text language model for Ivorian languages and that digital transition minister Djibril Ouattara called for national languages to be central to AI development. *Also under Digital divides.*

- **Nigeria loses $850m yearly to foreign cloud dependence, Luminate study finds** — BusinessDay NG, 22 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Data Storage.

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  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

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- **Africa must own its digital future or risk exploitation, says Luminate CEO** — TechCabal, 22 October 2026 NIGERIA AFRICA

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Capacity

Training and skills

- **MTN Rwanda signs cybersecurity MoU with National Cyber Security Authority** — Tech Review Africa, 22 October 2026 RWANDA

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Digital divides

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Summarised under AI.

- **Côte d'Ivoire promotes national languages in AI development through YIRI digital community** — Tech Review Africa, 22 October 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

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Geopolitics

Digital sovereignty

- **Nigeria loses $850m yearly to foreign cloud dependence, Luminate study finds** — BusinessDay NG, 22 October 2026 NIGERIA

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-23**
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This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the country pages. The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the catalogue.

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.